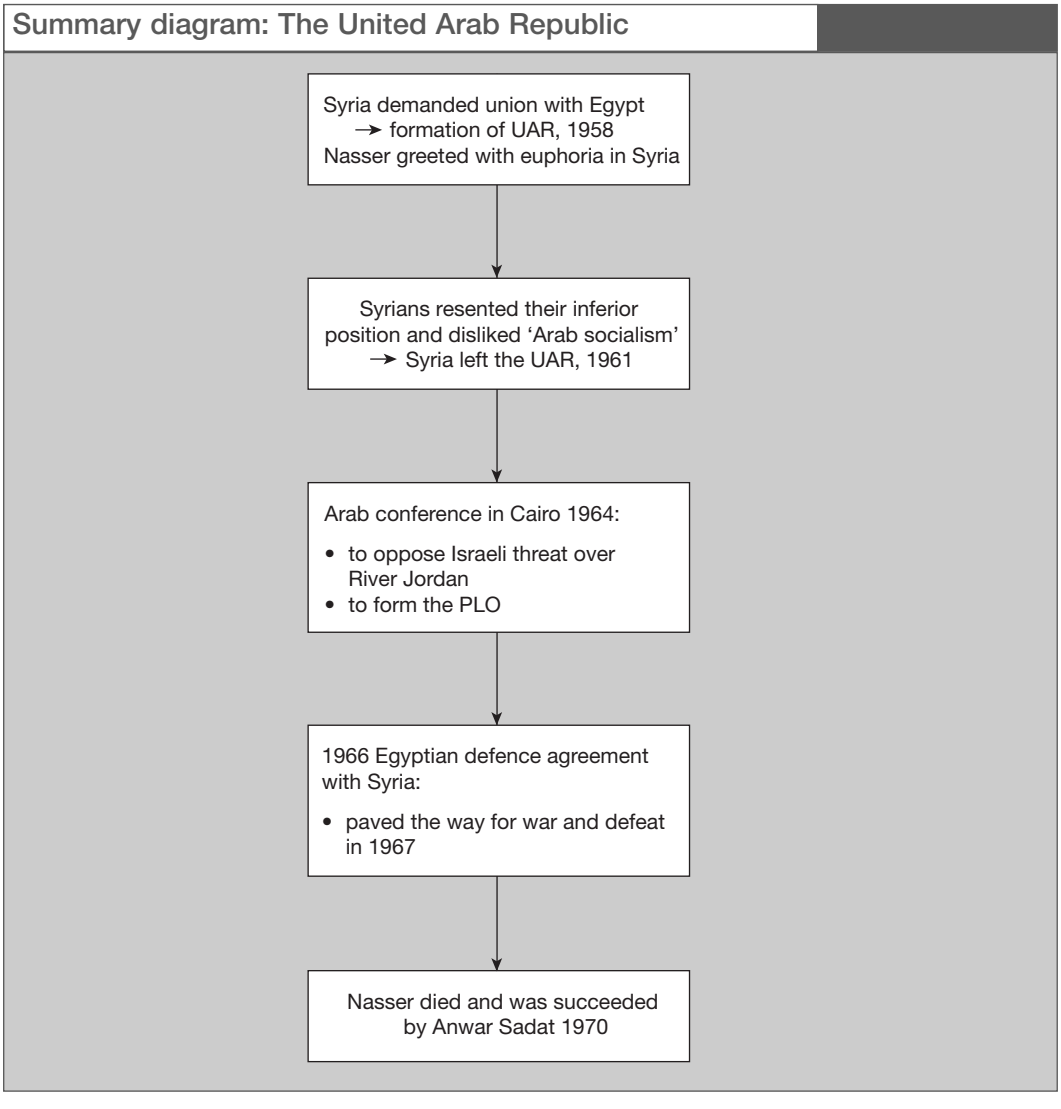
weakened. Nasser never fully recovered from the shock of the war and, in 1970, he died, aged 52, from a heart attack.

Nasser had brought unity to the Arab world and, although his influence was declining before he died, it was only after his death that the underlying divisions amongst the Arab states came to the surface and revealed how fragmented the Arab world had become.

Postscript: Anwar Sadat

Nasser's successor as President of Egypt was Anwar Sadat. He adopted a very different approach in his relations with Israel and the West. He went to war with Israel in 1973 (see page 55) but, afterwards, he sought US help in order to make peace with Israel. In recognising the state of Israel, he became, in the eyes of most of the Arab world, a traitor to the cause of Arab nationalism. This is dealt with more fully on pages 58–9.

Summary diagram: The United Arab Republic